

Firefox 7 lands in Aurora

Mozilla is offering firefox 7 via its Aurora channel in order to hasten its development cycle

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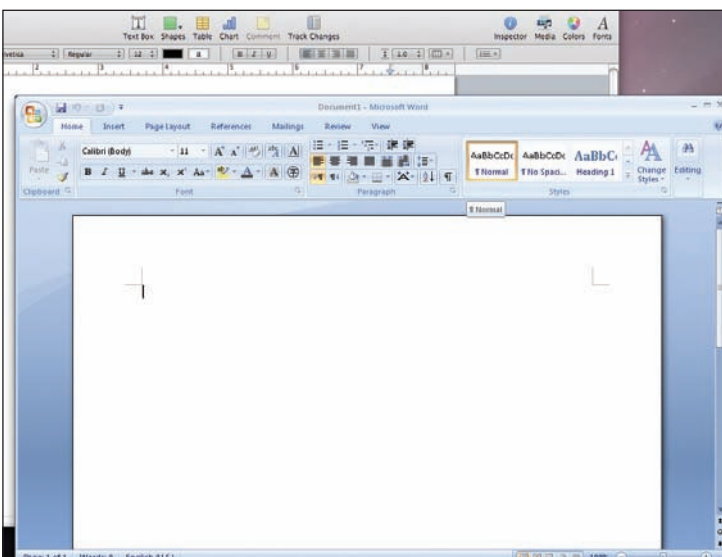
Cover Feature



Mass Effect 2 running on Linux using Wine



Amnesia: The Dark Descent, a critically acclaimed indie game that's available for Linux



Microsoft Office 2007 running on Ubuntu using CrossOver Office

few months as a new version rolls out, for free, while Windows comes every few years with a heavy price.

Linux is rightly advertised as the safer OS to use thanks to its lack of malware, but till now there's been no incentive to create malware for Linux. The increasing instances of malware reported for Mac OSX serve as a good indicator for what lies ahead for Linux. The worst part of it is that most Mac OSX users – many of whom have switched to the Unix-based OS just to get away from malware – are unaware that malware could infect their system and are thus unprepared.

The same might happen with Linux, but the beauty of Linux is that it might just fare better. Unlike Mac OSX and Windows, Linux is not only used by major corporations all over the world, but is even developed by said corporations. The Linux community can act faster against threats that crop up since more people have access to solutions to problems that exist and those that lie ahead.

Against Windows...

Now we come to the whole chicken and egg scenario. Certain applications are unavailable for Linux due to its small share, and Linux has a small share because certain applications are unavailable for it. We're going to break it to you – and you heard it here first – the egg came first. Unless the egg was laid on a radioactive pit, it had chicken DNA long before it became a chicken. Similarly, this Windows-Linux situation has a resolution as well.

Wine has shown great success in getting Windows applications to run on Linux, so much so that it can even run complex applications such as Microsoft Office 2007. There's a project, called Longene, in development that intends to include Wine in the Linux kernel, making Linux in essence compatible with Windows. On a Longene-based Linux distro, one will be able to install Windows drivers and software!

There's another huge aspect of Window that hasn't taken off on Linux yet, and that's gaming. The good news is that times are finally beginning to change. Wine is again very helpful here; you can